

A Peek Into Some Cloud Monitoring Tools

Cloud monitoring tools collect data and illustrate patterns that might be difficult to spot otherwise in a dynamic infrastructure environment, in which services are provided by Cloud Service Providers. Read on to know more...



Organisations are keen to leverage cloud computing to improve the agility and scalability. Conversely, those that have adopted cloud computing face the following challenge: decreased visibility into the performance and governance of services being delivered to their end users.

Cloud Service Providers (CSP) do provide dashboard facilities to track the status of their services; in addition, they provide alerts and notification mechanisms to recognise and report service outages in a timely manner. Customers also need to know the status of the applications on the cloud, and hence the need for continuous monitoring. Cloud monitoring refers to the monitoring of the performance of physical or virtual servers, storage systems, networks, and the applications running on them. Cloud monitoring tools can collect data and illustrate patterns that might be difficult to spot otherwise. To maintain high availability of applications, cloud monitoring tools can be used to collect metrics, gain

insights and perform corrective measures (in case required) to guarantee business continuity.

Monitored metrics

Cloud monitoring is essential for controlling and managing cloud resources and software infrastructure; it provides key performance indicators (KPI) for infrastructure, platforms, and applications.

Given below is a list of parameters that can be monitored by various open source tools, if not by a single solution.

- Application and cloud server response time
- Number of concurrent users
- Application and cloud server availability
- Network Latency
- Cloud service utilisation
- Overall bits/sec and requests/sec served by all of the processes